Prism & Connect

The Complete Script

Birla Pivot · Aditya Birla Group An interactive case study in 151 panels

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Before you read

This is a script, not a finished piece. It describes what appears on each panel, what is said, and why. Nothing has been illustrated yet, so the images exist only as direction.

The format is a keyboard-driven interactive comic, in the manner of growth.design. The reader taps or presses an arrow to advance one panel at a time. That mechanic governs everything below: a panel carrying one short line is a deliberate pause, and a silent panel is a held breath. Both are choices, not omissions.

How to read it. Straight through, once, without stopping on the notes. The dialogue should carry on its own. On a second pass the notes explain what each panel is for and which later beat it is setting up. If a line is hard to say aloud, it is wrong, and that is worth flagging.

Running time. Around eight minutes.

The cast

Vik · one of the two designers. Generates ideas, moves first, thinks out loud, is occasionally wrong in public and does not mind. Short sentences. Describes things physically rather than abstractly.

Nandini · the other designer. Slower, fewer words, and they land harder. She asks the question that ruins the good mood and is usually right to. The cross-question that produces the entire solution is hers.

Neither of them is the expert. They are two people who did not know whether this would work and said so repeatedly. Nandini is right more often than Vik. If a reader finishes this thinking Vik is the clever one and Nandini is the brake, the characterisation has failed.

Karishma · a Business Development Manager, and the person this is actually about. Not a case-study subject. Her voice is different from theirs: longer sentences, more specific about her work.

The Category Manager, the buyer, the seller · each appears briefly. None gets a second emotional journey.

Vik and Nandini are placeholder names.

Conventions

`VIK:` / `NANDINI:` / `KARISHMA:`	speech bubbles
Boxed blocks	call-out cards. Never spoken aloud. A different visual register from dialogue
Bold inside dialogue	the word carrying the stress
`M/A`	the marker position
`[X]`, `[N]`	a value still to be confirmed. Collected in the appendix

The marker is a small readout that appears in the corner of the frame at panel 27 and stays for the rest of the document. It is a position on the Fogg Behavior Model: Motivation on one axis, Ability on the other, with a threshold below which no prompt works. It is deliberately never explained in Act 2. It is named at panel 81, and the reveal that it was measuring something real all along is what turns the framework section into a payoff rather than a lecture.

The shape of it

Act	Panels	
1 · The mismatch	1 to 24	How the business ran, and the day it cost someone an order
2 · The audit, and the loss	25 to 63	Six hours inside the old tool, and the deal that died in them
3 · Connect, then Prism	64 to 111	The brainstorm, the cross-question, and the two answers to it
4 · The moment of truth	112 to 140	The same BDM, a live inquiry, and what happened
Coda	141 to 151	Four months, the numbers, and the close

A note on what this is arguing

Birla Pivot's business ran on phone calls and WhatsApp, because the BDM is in the field and the Category Manager is at a desk and no other channel reached both. Its software ran on a thirty-field form. Every order required someone to translate one into the other by hand, and the translation cost six hours and, often enough, the order itself.

The document makes that argument in a particular order. It shows the contradiction before naming it. It spends thirty panels making the reader feel a grind rather than describing one. It puts the framework after the question that needs it rather than before. And it keeps a

moment where the product failed in front of a user, because a flawless retest is the fastest way to lose a sceptical reader.

Act 1 · The mismatch

Panels 1 to 24 · The mismatch

Read the dialogue aloud. If a line is hard to say, it is wrong.

On Hindi. Per your instruction, everything is in English except `dhanda`, which is the settled hook. Two optional spice moments are flagged at panels 7 and 15 if you want more. They are marked and easy to remove.

Movement one: the dhanda

PANEL 1 · Cover

Visual. Two illustrated designers at a desk in the Birla Pivot office. Behind them, a window. On the desk, two laptops and a cup of something. Birla Pivot mark top left.

On-screen text.

> **Prism & Connect** AI-native chat platform for B2B procurement
> Story duration: 8 min *Use your keyboard arrows to move through the story*

Note. The keyboard instruction is load-bearing, not decorative. It sets the interaction the whole format depends on, and it is the first signal to the reader that this is not a scrolling page.

PANEL 2 · The hook

Visual. Same frame, pushed in slightly. Vik has turned towards Nandini. Feet up on a chair, informal.

> **VIK:** Dhanda at Birla Pivot was very **simple**.
> **NANDINI:** Was.

Note. First line of the document and it has to do three jobs: establish the register, violate the case-study expectation, and make the reader curious. Nandini's single word does the third one. It plants the idea that something changed before anyone says what.

PANEL 3 · Step one

Visual. Cut to an illustrated BDM at his desk, phone to his ear. Loose linework, unfussy.

> **VIK:** Was. Okay. A buyer calls the BDM and tells him what he needs.

Asset. Illustration.

PANEL 4 · Step two

Visual. Same frame. A speech bubble enters from off-panel, in the buyer's colour.

> **BUYER:** Thirty tonnes of TMT steel.

Note. Keep the requirement concrete and small. The reader needs to hold this number later when thirty line items arrive.

PANEL 5 · Step three

Visual. Cut to the BDM outside. A site, or a buyer's yard. Dust, a hard hat under one arm, material stacked behind him. He is not at a desk and there is no desk in sight.

> **VIK:** And the BDM is almost never at a desk. He is at the site, or at the buyer's office.

Note. NEW, AND IT CHANGES THE ACT. The BDM works in the field and the CM sits in the office. Establishing that here is what makes panel 8 inevitable rather than incidental.

PANEL 6 · Step four

Visual. Split panel. Left: the BDM outside, phone to his ear. Right: the CM at a desk, two monitors, three seller avatars around him. A thin line between them, and a lot of implied distance.

> **NANDINI:** The category manager is at the office. So the BDM calls him, and he checks prices with his sellers.

Note. The split-panel composition here rhymes with the Act 2 split-screen at panel 55 and with the two-device shot at panel 59. Same visual grammar, three different points in the story.

PANEL 7 · Step five

Visual. The quote travels back across that same gap. A PO document lands. Small handshake icon.

> **NANDINI:** If the margin works, he quotes it back. Buyer likes the number, sends the PO.
> **VIK:** Done. Same evening, sometimes.

Optional spice. Replace Vik's line with: *"Done. Same evening, sometimes. Seedha-saadha."* Flagged for your call.

PANEL 8 · The plant

Visual. Everything else drops away. A WhatsApp thread and a phone, alone on the panel. No people. This is the most visually spare panel so far and it should feel like the frame paused.

> **NANDINI:** All of it on phone calls and WhatsApp.

> **VIK:** All of it on phone calls and WhatsApp.

Note. THE LOAD-BEARING FACT. The repetition is the device that makes the reader hold onto it without anyone flagging its importance. It lands harder now that panels 5 and 6 have established the distance: nobody chose phone and WhatsApp, it was the only channel that reached both of them. Do not add a third line. Do not explain why it matters. It pays off at panel 15 and again in Act 3.

PANEL 9 · Business context

Visual. A call-out card, visually distinct from dialogue. Neutral, third person, data-card register.

> **THE BUSINESS PROBLEM**
> **[X]**% of inquiries were lost to late response. Over **[Y]** leads sat untapped, with no BDM bandwidth to follow up.
> Birla Pivot is a B2B materials marketplace in the Aditya Birla Group. Buyers, sellers, and the team in between.

Note. This is the concession to the reader who came for numbers. It is planted early because the outcome metrics do not arrive until panel 148, and a reader who needs evidence should not have to wait eight minutes for the first of it. Keep it short. It is a card, not a section.

Movement two: lunch

PANEL 10 · Scene change

Visual. Wide. The office canteen. Three people at a table with trays. Ambient, busy, unremarkable.

> **VIK:** This is a Tuesday. We are at lunch.

Note. Lower the temperature deliberately before the inciting incident. No research session, no complaint ticket, no discovery workshop. Lunch. The casualness of the setting is what makes the next four panels feel found rather than staged.

PANEL 11 · The vent

Visual. Karishma, mid-sentence, fork paused. She is not performing frustration. She is describing her Monday.

> **KARISHMA:** I wasted my **entire day** yesterday trying to punch an order.

Note. Her voice is different from theirs. Longer sentences, more specific about her work. She is the only person at this table who does this job.

PANEL 12 · The turn of the knife

Visual. Same frame. Nothing moves. Let the panel be still.

> **KARISHMA:** And the order got cancelled.

Note. This line gets its own panel. On a tap-to-advance format, a panel with one short line is a pause, and this is where a pause belongs.

PANEL 13 · Human first

Visual. Both designers. Faces. Neither is reaching for a notebook.

> **VIK:** That's... really sad.

Note. CRITICAL TONE BEAT. The instinct here is to jump to analysis, and the instinct is wrong. A reader can tell the difference between two people who were moved and two people who smelled a case study. If only one line in Act 1 survives editing intact, make it this one.

PANEL 14 · The question

Visual. Nandini leans in slightly.

> **NANDINI:** Why did it take a whole day?

Note. Five words that start the entire investigation. She asks one question and then stops talking, which is the character working exactly as specified.

PANEL 15 · The contradiction lands

Visual. Karishma gestures at the size of the thing. Hands apart.

> **KARISHMA:** Have you seen the inquiry form? Thirty line items. Every single one by hand.

Note. THE READER FEELS THE CONTRADICTION HERE, seven panels after we planted it. A business that runs on phone calls, and software that runs on forms. Nobody names it. The naming happens at panel 23, after it has been felt.

Optional spice. *"Poora din just filling boxes."* Flagged for your call.

PANEL 16 · The wait

Visual. Karishma, still talking. Perhaps a small inset of a status screen that says nothing useful.

> **KARISHMA:** And then I'm just waiting. The category manager hasn't responded, and there's no way to know if he's even opened it.

Note. Seeds the no-reminders problem that pays off twice: at panel 52 in the audit, and in Act 3 when Prism's reminders arrive.

PANEL 17 · The absurdity

Visual. Same frame. She shrugs, the shrug of someone describing a normal Tuesday.

> **KARISHMA:** By six o'clock I called him anyway. Like I always do.

PANEL 18 · THE QUOTE

Visual. Full bleed. Everything stripped. Large type, quotation marks, her name and role beneath in small caps. No illustration, no background, no bubble.

> *"I waste so much time filling out the forms even though at the end of the day I have to call him anyway to get my answer."*
> KARISHMA · BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT MANAGER

Note. The thesis of the entire case study, spoken by the person it is about, in her own words, eighteen panels in. The format change is the emphasis. This is the first time the document stops looking like a comic.

Movement three: the pattern break

PANEL 19 · Pattern, beat one

Visual. Illustrated Karishma at her computer, seen from behind and slightly above. Clicking.

No dialogue.

PANEL 20 · Pattern, beat two

Visual. Identical framing, pushed in. Still clicking. The only change is scale.

No dialogue.

PANEL 21 · Pattern, beat three

Visual. Identical framing, tighter again. Still clicking.

No dialogue.

Note. Three silent panels is a risk on a tap-to-advance format and it is the correct risk. The reader has to become slightly bored for the next panel to work. Do not add a caption to fill the space.

PANEL 22 · PATTERN BREAK

Visual. REAL FOOTAGE. Karishma at her actual desk, in the actual office, doing exactly what the illustration was doing. Her face is not visible. Same framing as the three panels before it, so the substitution is unmistakable.

No dialogue.

Asset. Karishma desk footage. No face. Shared with her permission.

Note. HIGHEST-VALUE CRAFT BEAT IN THE DOCUMENT. It converts the reader's understanding from "someone made up a story to explain their design" into "these people were in the room." Everything after this panel inherits that credibility, including the audit, including the retest. We set a pattern, then broke it. Do not caption it, do not label it "real user research," do not put a play button on it. The unannounced substitution is the whole effect.

PANEL 23 · The naming

Visual. Call-out card over a dimmed version of the previous frame.

> **NN/g HEURISTIC · MATCH BETWEEN THE SYSTEM AND THE REAL WORLD**
> A system should speak the user's language, with words and concepts familiar to them, rather than internal jargon. It should follow real-world conventions and make information appear in a natural, logical order.
> The business ran on conversations. The software ran on forms. Every order was a translation between the two, done by hand, by the person least able to spare the time.

Note. The theory arrives only after the reader has felt the thing it describes. Card register, never dialogue. The last paragraph is ours, not NN/g's, and should be visually separated from the definition.

PANEL 24 · The turn

Visual. Back to the two designers. Detective hats appear. A magnifying glass. Full, unembarrassed silliness, deployed at precisely the moment the document would otherwise turn earnest.

> **VIK:** I have never actually watched someone fill that form.
> **NANDINI:** Neither have I.
> **VIK:** Should we?

Note. Three bubbles is the maximum and this panel earns it because the rhythm is the joke. The tonal whiplash between the NN/g card and the detective hats is intentional; it is the same move Growth.Design makes when they cut from a psychology insight to someone lying on a couch.

Transition into Act 2. Hard cut to the Pluto dashboard. No establishing panel, no "so we opened the tool." The next thing the reader sees is the screen, and the marker appears in the corner, unexplained.

Notes for the illustrator

- **Panels 3 to 7** are one continuous sequence and should share a palette and camera height. They are the "before" world and need to feel warm and fast.

- **Panel 8** is the first spare panel. Give it air.
- **Panels 19 to 22** must be framed identically. The effect dies if the camera moves.
- **Panel 18** and **panel 23** are the only two panels in Act 1 that are typographic rather than illustrated. They are the two places the document speaks in its own voice.

Act 2 · The audit, and the loss

Panels 25 to 63 · The audit, and the loss

The longest act and the one that can lose the reader. Its job is accumulation, not completeness: the reader should feel the same slow grind the BDM feels, then be released from it. The risk is conveying tedium by being tedious. The defence is that every movement is shorter than the reader expects.

Marker. Appears at panel 27, unlabelled, axes unnamed, bottom-left corner of the frame. It is never explained in this act. It is named at panel 81.

Voice. Vik and Nandini narrate the tool as the BDM would think it, not as designers critiquing it. Blunt, funny, occasionally unfair. They are not being fair to Pluto and they should not be.

Bridge: how the requirement actually arrives

PANEL 25 · Morning, in the field

Visual. A site. Steel stacked behind them. The buyer talking, gesturing at the stack. The BDM listening, phone in his hand, not writing anything down.

> **VIK:** The requirement never arrives as a document.

Asset. Illustration.

Note. NEW. This is the panel that makes Obstacle 1 structural rather than a personal failing.

PANEL 26 · In pieces

Visual. Three fragments stacked vertically, each timestamped. `9:40 AM` a call. `11:15 AM` a WhatsApp voice note. `2:05 PM` an email with a scanned list attached.

> **NANDINI:** It comes in pieces. Over hours. Across three different apps.
> **VIK:** Because sitting the buyer down and asking for all of it at once takes a week.

Note. THE MOST IMPORTANT NEW PANEL IN THE DOCUMENT. The form demands a complete picture at a single moment. The picture never exists at a single moment. Everything wrong in the next thirty panels follows from this, and Prism's answer in Act 3 is the only shape that fits it.

Movement one: getting in

PANEL 27 · The desk

Visual. Cut. His desk, after lunch. Laptop open. The Pluto dashboard, rebuilt clean. In the bottom-left of the frame, a small marker widget appears for the first time. No axes labels, no legend, no explanation.

> **VIK:** Okay. New inquiry. Where do I... where do I even start.

M/A. 55 / 35

Note. The marker enters unannounced and stays for the rest of the document. Do not caption it. Readers tolerate an unexplained readout far longer than designers expect, and the payoff at panel 81 depends on it having been there all along.

PANEL 28 · The plus

Visual. A zoom ring lands on a small plus icon tucked into a corner of the toolbar.

> **NANDINI:** There.
> **VIK:** Where?
> **NANDINI:** The plus. In the corner.
> **VIK:** That plus? That is a **very** small plus.

M/A. 52 / 28

Note. Four bubbles, which breaks the two-bubble rule, and it earns it because the rhythm is the joke. This is the only panel in the act with four.

PANEL 29 · Upload a document

Visual. A modal asking him to upload the inquiry document.

> **VIK:** It wants a document.
> **NANDINI:** He has a voice note and a photo of a list.

M/A. 48 / 25

PANEL 30 · Manual inquiry

Visual. A menu with two options. One of them reads `Manual Inquiry`.

> **VIK:** "Manual inquiry."
> **NANDINI:** Mm.
> **VIK:** As opposed to?
> **NANDINI:** Exactly.

M/A. 45 / 24

> **SYSTEM LANGUAGE**

> The option is named after the backend process that creates it, not the job the user is doing. Every inquiry this BDM has ever raised was manual. The word only means something to the people who built it.

Note. Movement one is deliberately fast and funny. Five panels, light touch, out.

PANEL 31 · The form opens

Visual. A multi-step form. A step indicator at the top showing a number of steps that is not small.

> **VIK:** How many of these are there?

M/A. 42 / 22

Movement two: the questions he cannot answer

PANEL 32 · Parent quote

Visual. A field labelled `Parent Quote`. Empty. Cursor blinking.

> **VIK:** Parent quote.
> **NANDINI:** Do you know what that is?
> **VIK:** No.

M/A. 40 / 20

Note. Verbatim Pluto labels from here to panel 38. Real jargon is always funnier than invented jargon, and it is also the evidence.

PANEL 33 · Scope of unloading

Visual. A field labelled `Scope of Unloading`.

> **VIK:** I didn't ask my buyer this.

M/A. 38 / 18

Note. Switch to first person here. From this panel to the end of the audit, Vik is speaking as the BDM rather than about him. It should not be announced and the reader will not notice consciously.

PANEL 34 · Call one

Visual. A phone icon enters the frame, top right. A tally begins: `CALL 1`.

> **VIK:** So now I call him again.

M/A. 36 / 18

Note. The tally sits in the same corner for the rest of the act and increments quietly. Never remarked on after this panel. It is doing the work that fifteen "and another call" panels would otherwise do.

PANEL 35 · Expected ETA

Visual. A field labelled `Expected ETA`. A red asterisk beside it. Below, in small red text: `This field is required`.

> **VIK:** Expected ETA. I haven't spoken to the seller yet. I don't have an ETA.
> **NANDINI:** It's mandatory.

M/A. 34 / 16

PANEL 36 · The number

Visual. Hold on the field. He types a date. The asterisk goes quiet. Nothing else in the frame moves.

> **VIK:** So he types a number.
> **NANDINI:** He types a number.
> **VIK:** Every day. Every inquiry. Somebody types a number.

M/A. 32 / 15

> **A REQUIRED FIELD YOU CANNOT ANSWER DOES NOT PROTECT YOUR DATA**
> It manufactures bad data, quietly, at scale. This inquiry now carries a delivery date that nobody believes, in a system that other teams plan against.

Note. SECOND USE OF THE REPETITION DEVICE, here for weight rather than setup. No outrage in the dialogue. The card says the hard thing so the characters do not have to.

PANEL 37 · Credit availability

Visual. A field labelled `Credit Availability`.

> **VIK:** Don't know.

M/A. 30 / 15

PANEL 38 · Buyer's asked price

Visual. A field labelled `Buyer's Asked Price`.

> **VIK:** Never asked him. He'd have told me if I'd asked.

M/A. 29 / 14

Note. Deliberately rueful rather than angry. The system asked at the wrong time, not the wrong question.

PANEL 39 · OBSTACLE 1

Visual. Full panel. Typographic. The call tally, now at `CALL 4`, sits in the corner.

> **OBSTACLE 1 He didn't collect enough information from the buyer.**
> Not because he was careless. Because the information arrives in pieces, over hours, across three apps, and the form wants all of it at once.

M/A. 28 / 14

Note. This panel is the Act 3 pivot and the Act 4 payoff, so the second paragraph matters more than the headline. Without it the reader blames the BDM.

Movement three: thirty line items

PANEL 40 · The list

Visual. The buyer's list, the one from the emailed scan. Twenty-odd lines of steel, handwritten.

> **NANDINI:** He could have done this in the field. Pluto works on a phone.
> **VIK:** Thirty line items. On a phone.
> **NANDINI:** Right.

M/A. 28 / 14

Note. Closes the field-versus-desk question without making a meal of it. The tool was reachable. It was not usable in the place he actually works.

PANEL 41 · One

Visual. He searches `TMT steel`. A results list. He picks a variant and adds it. A counter appears: `1 OF 30`.

No dialogue.

M/A. 27 / 13

PANEL 42 · Two

Visual. Identical frame. `2 OF 30`.

No dialogue.

M/A. 26 / 12

Note. Two silent identical panels to establish the unit of labour, exactly like panels 19 to 21. The reader learns the shape of the work, then we accelerate.

PANEL 43 · The grind

Visual. One panel, accelerating. The counter spins: `3` … `11` … `19 OF 30`. Search, scroll, select, add, repeated to a blur. Timestamps in the corner sliding forward.

No dialogue.

M/A. 22 / 9

Note. This single panel replaces roughly fifteen literal additions. The counter conveys the labour more economically than the labour does, and it is the main reason the audit fits in 39 panels instead of sixty.

PANEL 44 · The filter

Visual. He applies a filter. The list does not change.

> **NANDINI:** Did that do anything?
> **VIK:** No.

M/A. 20 / 8

PANEL 45 · The cart

Visual. He opens the cart. It shows a count and nothing else. No list of what is in it.

> **VIK:** So I can't see what I've already added.
> **NANDINI:** You can see that there are twenty-six of them.
> **VIK:** Twenty-six of **what**.

M/A. 19 / 8

PANEL 46 · OBSTACLE 2

Visual. Full panel. Typographic. Behind the text, ghosted, the counter at `30 OF 30`. The timestamp says it took four hours.

> **OBSTACLE 2 Thirty line items. All by hand.**
> Four hours of a salesperson's day, spent typing things the buyer had already told him.

M/A. 16 / 7

Note. LARGEST SINGLE DROP IN THE DOCUMENT. The marker should visibly lurch here.

Movement four: the close, and the wait

PANEL 47 · Deal amount

Visual. The summary page. A field labelled `Deal Amount`.

> **VIK:** Deal amount. I don't have prices yet. That's the whole reason I'm here.

M/A. 15 / 7

PANEL 48 · Payment terms

Visual. A field labelled `Payment Terms`.

> **VIK:** Call five.

M/A. 14 / 6

Note. The tally has been running silently for fourteen panels. This is the only time anyone mentions it, and it lands because they haven't.

PANEL 49 · Assign a CM

Visual. Submit is greyed. An inline error: `Please assign a Category Manager to proceed`.

> **VIK:** I have to tell it who to send it to.
> **NANDINI:** It doesn't know?

M/A. 13 / 6

PANEL 50 · Submit

Visual. He submits. The status chip reads `AWAITING RESPONSE`.

> **VIK:** Okay. Done. That's the hard part over.

M/A. 15 / 6

Note. Small marker rise. He believes the work is finished. This is a setup, and the reader who has been paying attention already knows it.

PANEL 51 · Nothing moves

Visual. He watches the status chip. It does not change. The frame does not change.

> **VIK:** Will it tell me when he opens it?
> **NANDINI:** No.
> **VIK:** Will it tell me anything?
> **NANDINI:** No.

M/A. 14 / 6

Note. Pluto had no notifications of any kind. This is the setup for Prism's reminders in Act 3, and it is a genuine absence rather than a weak feature, which makes the payoff real.

PANEL 52 · One hour

Visual. Clock. `3:00 PM`.

No dialogue.

M/A. 14 / 6

PANEL 53 · Two hours

Visual. Clock. `4:00 PM`.

> **KARISHMA:** My buyer is waiting.

M/A. 12 / 5

Note. Karishma's voice returns here for the first time since Act 1, briefly. It reminds the reader whose day this is.

PANEL 54 · Three hours

Visual. Clock. `5:00 PM`.

> **KARISHMA:** Why hasn't the category manager responded?

M/A. 10 / 5

PANEL 55 · The other side

Visual. SPLIT SCREEN. Same composition as panel 6. Her on the left. The CM on the right, at his desk, a long list of seller quotes on screen.

> **CM:** I have so many quotes. I have to go through all of them to find the best one.

M/A. frozen

Note. Brief. Not a second journey. One emotional arc per document or both dilute.

PANEL 56 · Precision

Visual. Call-out card.

> **THIS IS A DISCOVERABILITY PROBLEM, NOT A SPEED PROBLEM**
> The category manager is not slow. He is looking at everything at once, with nothing telling him which quote is worth opening first.

Note. Keeping this distinction precise is what makes the recommended-sellers feature in Act 4 an honest answer rather than a convenient one.

PANEL 57 · Prices

Visual. `6:10 PM`. The quotes arrive. The summary screen finally has numbers in it.

No dialogue.

M/A. 20 / 8

PANEL 58 · Assembling the answer

Visual. He scrolls the summary, reading across rows, working out what he can quote.

> **VIK:** Okay. So I can do the 8mm at this, and the 10mm at this...

M/A. 25 / 10

PANEL 59 · TWO DEVICES

Visual. THE PANEL. Wide. He is at his laptop with the price on screen, and his phone is in his other hand, WhatsApp open, thumb typing. The same split composition as panel 6 and panel 55, except now both halves are the same man.

No dialogue. No caption. No commentary.

M/A. 25 / 10

Note. HOLD THIS PANEL. It indicts the entire system without a word, and any line of dialogue would weaken it. The visual grammar has been training the reader for this since panel 6: a split frame has meant two people in two places, and now it means one man doing the work of the gap between them.

Movement five: the loss

PANEL 60 · The reply

Visual. The WhatsApp thread. His quote. Then, beneath it, the reply.

> **BUYER:** I've already got a better deal somewhere else.

M/A. 10 / 8

PANEL 61 · Lost

Visual. The Pluto inquiry screen. The status chip changes to `LOST`. The screen desaturates.

No dialogue.

M/A. 6 / 6

Note. One buyer, one inquiry, one loss. Specificity is what makes this land. It is not the accumulated frustration of a difficult tool; it is a deal that existed at nine in the morning and does not exist at seven at night.

PANEL 62 · For what

Visual. Karishma at her desk. Still. The call tally, still in the corner, reads `CALL 6`.

> **KARISHMA:** I wasted so much time. For what?

M/A. 4 / 5

PANEL 63 · FLOOR

Visual. The desk, empty. He has gone home. The laptop is closed. The marker sits at the bottom-left corner of the frame, as low as it goes.

No dialogue.

M/A. 4 / 5

Note. PSYCH FLOOR. One full panel of nothing. The reader needs a moment of silence before Act 3 arrives with detective hats, and this is the panel that buys the tonal shift.

Transition into Act 3. Cut to the detective board. The tonal jump from this silence to Vik saying "So we trailed the suspect for a day" is large and deliberate.

Pacing check

Movement	Panels	Count
Bridge: the requirement	25 to 26	2
One: getting in	27 to 31	5
Two: questions he can't answer	32 to 39	8
Three: thirty line items	40 to 46	7
Four: the close and the wait	47 to 58	12
Five: the loss	59 to 63	5
Act 2 total		**39**

Audit proper is 20 panels against the 22 to 26 budget, with the bridge and the wait accounting for the rest. Silent panels: 41, 42, 43, 52, 57, 59, 61, 63. Eight of thirty-nine, clustered in the grind and the ending, which is where silence does the most work.

Act 3 · Connect, then Prism

Panels 64 to 111 · Connect, then Prism

The biggest act, and the one with the opposite risk to Act 2. There the danger was tedium. Here it is a speed bump. The reader has just watched a man lose a deal and has been promised a chat platform, so this is the point of maximum velocity, and a framework explanation dropped into it reads as homework.

The defence is that the framework never gets taught on its own terms. It arrives because Nandini asks a question Vik cannot answer, and it is used to answer her. Motivation is

answered by Connect, Ability by Prism, Prompt by the AI layer. The theory itself lives in cards that run alongside for readers who want them.

Marker. Named at panel 81 and legible from there on. This is the act where the reader learns what they have been looking at since panel 27.

Movement one: the method

PANEL 64 · The board

Visual. A detective board. Photographs, string, pins. Printouts of Pluto screens. Both designers in front of it, hats still on.

> **VIK:** Before we fixed anything, we followed him.

Note. The conceit earns the method rather than decorating it. A diary study is a serious piece of work and this framing makes it readable without making it sound like a deliverable.

PANEL 65 · Method

Visual. Call-out card.

> **METHOD · DIARY STUDY**
> **[N]** BDMs, shadowed over **[N]** days on live inquiries. We recorded what they did, what tool they were in, and what they were trying to get done. Shared with their permission.

PANEL 66 · The day

Visual. A single horizontal bar representing one working day, segmented and labelled. A large block of Pluto. A large block of calls and WhatsApp. A thin sliver labelled `Selling`.

No dialogue.

Note. This is the only conventional data visualisation in the document and it works because it is the only one. Let the proportions speak.

PANEL 67 · The thesis

Visual. Both designers, looking at the bar.

> **NANDINI:** He isn't a salesman any more. He's a data entry operator.

Note. THE THESIS LINE OF THE CASE STUDY. Nandini gets it because it is a conclusion, not an idea, and conclusions are hers.

Movement two: the brainstorm, including the failures

PANEL 68 · First idea

Visual. Whiteboard. Vik writing. `Put all the fields on one page`.

> **VIK:** Put all the fields on one page. No steps, no next, no back.

PANEL 69 · Rejected

Visual. The line struck through.

> **NANDINI:** Then it's one very long page instead of six short ones.

> **COGNITIVE LOAD**
> Consolidating a long form onto a single page relocates the burden. It does not reduce it. The work is the same; the reader can now see all of it at once, which is worse.

PANEL 70 · Second idea

Visual. `Remove some fields`.

> **NANDINI:** Remove some of them.
> **VIK:** Which ones? Every team that asked for a field had a reason.

PANEL 71 · Third idea

Visual. `Remove ALL of them`.

> **VIK:** Remove all of them.
> **NANDINI:** And then how does the order get placed?

PANEL 72 · Fourth idea

Visual. `Capture only header details`.

> **VIK:** Okay. We only capture header details up front, and the rest comes later.

PANEL 73 · Struck through twice

Visual. The line struck through, then struck through again.

> **NANDINI:** No BDM on earth knows what a header detail is.

Note. Rejected as a solution and rejected as language, in one line. Good joke, real point: half of Pluto's problems were vocabulary.

PANEL 74 · The pivot

Visual. Vik stops pacing. The whiteboard is behind him, covered in struck-through lines.

> **VIK:** What is actually wrong with collecting it unstructured?

Note. The pivot arrives as a question rather than an answer. It also arrives from the failures, which is why keeping all five of them matters. Growth.Design shows the solutions that failed them, and the failures are what make the working idea look earned instead of inevitable.

PANEL 75 · Beat

Visual. Neither of them says anything. The whiteboard, the two of them, a pause.

No dialogue.

PANEL 76 · LIGHTBULB

Visual. Full panel.

> **VIK:** What if we just capture the chats?

Note. MAXIMUM READER VELOCITY STARTS HERE. Everything from this panel to 104 is working against the reader's impatience.

Movement three: the cross-question

PANEL 77 · The question

Visual. Nandini, immediately, flat. No beat, no reaction shot. She is already talking.

> **NANDINI:** Why would they come to us?

Note. THE HINGE OF THE DOCUMENT. It must land as a real objection, which means it cannot be preceded by a pause. She has been thinking it since panel 74.

PANEL 78 · The full objection

Visual. Same frame.

> **NANDINI:** They're on WhatsApp. It works, it's free, and every buyer they sell to is already there. Why would a single BDM open our thing instead?
> **NANDINI:** And don't say because leadership will make them.

Note. She pre-empts the weak answer, which is the most useful thing a sceptic can do. It signals to the reader that the easy answer has been considered and rejected, so the real one has to be better. This is the difference between a case study and a feature list.

PANEL 79 · Conceded

Visual. Vik stops. Beat.

> **VIK:** ...Okay. Good question.

Movement four: the framework, used rather than taught

PANEL 80 · Axes

Visual. The whiteboard is wiped. Two axes drawn. `Motivation` vertical, `Ability` horizontal. Nothing else.

> **VIK:** Alright. Two things have to be true before anybody does anything.

Note. The framework enters as a tool grabbed mid-argument, not as a section. Nobody says "let us apply a framework."

PANEL 81 · THE REVEAL

Visual. The marker from Act 2 lifts out of the corner of the frame and lands on the chart, bottom-left. Same marker, same shape, same colour. The reader has been watching it for fifty-four panels.

> **VIK:** This is where he was. The whole time.

M/A. 4 / 5

Note. THE PAYOFF THAT MAKES THE TEACHING A REWARD. The reader spent Act 2 watching an unexplained widget slide down and left, and now learns it was measuring something real the entire time. Act 2 becomes retroactively rigorous. This panel is the reason the framework does not read as homework.

PANEL 82 · The model

Visual. Call-out card.

> **#PSYCHOLOGY INSIGHT · BEHAVIOR MAP**
> **B = M · A · P.** A behaviour happens when Motivation, Ability and a Prompt arrive at the same moment. Remove any one and nothing happens, however strong the other two are.
> BJ Fogg, Behavior Design Lab, Stanford University.

PANEL 83 · The threshold

Visual. The dashed activation-threshold curve is drawn across the chart. The marker sits well below it.

> **NANDINI:** Below this line, nothing you do works.

M/A. 4 / 5

PANEL 84 · The prompt that never worked

Visual. A prompt burst fires next to the marker. Nothing moves. The burst fades.

> **VIK:** Every reminder Pluto ever sent him was below this line.
> **NANDINI:** Pluto never sent him anything.
> **VIK:** Right. Even better.

M/A. 4 / 5

Note. PAYOFF OF PANEL 51 with a concrete referent the reader watched. The joke also does real work: the absence of notifications was not a missing feature, it was a system that had given up on prompting anyone.

PANEL 85 · Ability, defined

Visual. Call-out card.

> **#PSYCHOLOGY INSIGHT · THE FIVE ABILITY RESOURCES**
> Time · Money · Physical capacity · Mental capacity · Practice.
> Ability is capped by whichever is scarcest at the moment of action. For a BDM mid-deal, the scarce ones are time and mental capacity, and the old inquiry form spent both before he had a single price.

PANEL 86 · Two directions

Visual. Two arrows drawn from the marker. One straight up. One straight right.

> **VIK:** So we need two different things. Not one.

M/A. 4 / 5

Note. STRUCTURAL HINGE. This is where the two-product reveal becomes inevitable rather than a coincidence of naming, and it is why the cross-question earns the framework.

Movement five: Connect answers Motivation

PANEL 87 · Title

Visual. Title card. `CONNECT`. Beneath it, small: `The chat layer`. The Motivation arrow glows.

> **VIK:** Don't make them come to us. Go to where they already are.

PANEL 88 · One handle

Visual. Rebuilt screen. A single Birla Pivot number. Outbound messages arriving in the buyer's WhatsApp. Inbound landing in the Connect inbox.

> **VIK:** One Birla Pivot handle. He sends from our platform, it lands in the buyer's WhatsApp. Buyer replies on WhatsApp, it lands with us.
> **NANDINI:** The buyer doesn't install anything.

Note. The most important thing about Connect is what the buyer is NOT asked to do. Say it in Nandini's voice so it reads as a check rather than a claim.

PANEL 89 · Groups

Visual. Two Connect groups side by side. One with the buyer. One with the CM.

> **VIK:** A group with the buyer. A group with the category manager. Same app, same thread, no forwarding.

Note. Callback to panel 55, the split-screen, and to panel 59, the two-device shot. The gap the BDM was manually bridging is now inside one window.

PANEL 90 · Effort follows intent

Visual. A cold inquiry sitting as a plain conversation, no form anywhere. Then a PO arrives, and only then does a structured record appear.

> **VIK:** While it's cold, it stays a conversation. The moment a PO lands, it becomes an order.
> **NANDINI:** So nobody fills anything in until somebody has actually decided to buy.

PANEL 91 · The principle

Visual. Call-out card.

> **EFFORT SHOULD SCALE WITH DEMONSTRATED INTENT**
> The old system demanded its heaviest work at the coldest moment of a deal, from the person least able to spare the time, before anyone knew whether the order was real.

Note. THE SHARPEST STRATEGIC IDEA IN THE DOCUMENT and the most portable to other products. It is also takeaway 2.

PANEL 92 · Still red

Visual. The marker climbs the Motivation axis. It rises a long way. It is still, unmistakably, in the red.

No dialogue.

M/A. 60 / 5

Note. CRITICAL TEACHING BEAT. The temptation is to let Connect be the answer and move on. Resisting it is what makes Prism feel necessary rather than additional, and it is also the clearest demonstration of the model the document will get.

PANEL 93 · The gap

Visual. Nandini, looking at the marker.

> **NANDINI:** He wants to. He still can't.

M/A. 60 / 5

Movement six: Prism answers Ability

PANEL 94 · Title

Visual. Title card. `PRISM`. Beneath it, small: `The layer on top of Connect`. The Ability arrow glows.

> **VIK:** Connect gets him there. Prism is why he stays.

PANEL 95 · Reading the conversation

Visual. Rebuilt screen, split. Chat on the left. An inquiry on the right, filling itself as the messages arrive. The three fragments from panel 26 land one after another and the inquiry updates each time.

> **VIK:** It reads the conversation and fills the inquiry in.
> **NANDINI:** As it arrives. Not all at once.

Note. THE SINGLE MOST IMPORTANT SCREEN IN THE DOCUMENT, and the direct answer to panel 26. Information arrives in pieces over hours across three apps, so the inquiry accepts pieces over hours. Use the same three timestamps.

PANEL 96 · Thirty of thirty

Visual. Line items filling progressively. The counter runs upward on its own: `12 OF 30` … `30 OF 30`. Identical counter to panel 43, running the other way.

> **VIK:** He checks it. He doesn't type it.

M/A. —

Note. DELIBERATE MIRROR of the worst beat in the audit. Same component, same position on screen, opposite direction. Four hours becomes a scroll.

PANEL 97 · Reminders

Visual. A reminder fires. A nudge about an inquiry that has gone quiet.

> **NANDINI:** And it tells him when something moves.
> **VIK:** Which Pluto never did.

M/A. —

Note. Payoff of panel 51.

PANEL 98 · The PO

Visual. A PO arrives in the chat. The system reads it. A verification screen appears with everything already filled.

> **VIK:** PO arrives, it reads it, he checks it once.

Note. SEEDS THE ACT 4 CLIMAX. Do not over-explain and do not show the autofill in full here. The reader should register the capability and not yet feel it. The feeling is panel 137's job.

PANEL 99 · Green

Visual. The marker travels right, crosses the dashed threshold, and settles inside the green zone. First time in the document.

No dialogue.

M/A. 60 / 85

Note. Let this be silent. It is the first good news in ninety-nine panels.

PANEL 100 · The lever

Visual. Call-out card.

> **WHEN A BEHAVIOUR FAILS, REDUCE THE COST BEFORE YOU INCREASE THE PERSUASION**
> Motivation is expensive to buy and it decays. Ability, once designed for, compounds. A man who wanted to do his job was never the problem.

Movement seven: the Prompt

PANEL 101 · The AI layer

Visual. A band drawn across both product cards, labelled. A prompt burst fires inside the green zone this time, and the marker moves.

> **VIK:** And now a nudge actually lands.

M/A. 85 / 90

PANEL 102 · What it does

Visual. Four small screens in a row: a nudge on a quiet inquiry, a missing-information alert, a seller recommendation, a closing prompt.

> **NANDINI:** Tell him what's gone quiet. Tell him what he forgot to ask. Tell the category manager which quote to open first.

M/A. 85 / 90

Note. The second clause plants Act 4's biggest payoff. Say it once, lightly, and never mention it again until panel 131.

PANEL 103 · The whole journey

Visual. Full B=MAP. The journey line drawn from the Act 2 floor, up through Connect, right through Prism, into the corner.

No dialogue.

M/A. 85 / 90

Note. The entire thesis in one image. Reprised in the coda at panel 148.

Movement eight: the doubt, and the prototype

PANEL 104 · The doubt

Visual. Nandini, arms folded, looking at the chart.

> **NANDINI:** Sounds good on a whiteboard. Are we sure it actually works?

Note. Never let the idea win unopposed. This is the third time she has stopped him and it is the one that produces the prototype.

PANEL 105 · The cost

Visual. Both of them.

> **VIK:** Let's test it.
> **NANDINI:** That's a lot of engineering effort to find out.

PANEL 106 · The decision

Visual. Vik, already turning to his laptop.

> **VIK:** Then let's not ask engineering. Let's build it ourselves.
> **NANDINI:** ...Can we?
> **VIK:** Let's find out.

Note. Her "can we" is genuine uncertainty, not a setup. They did not know. That is the honest version and it is also the more interesting one.

PANEL 107 · One week

Visual. A week compressed. Prototype screens taking shape. Claude and Figma Make visible in the frame, not hidden.

> **VIK:** One week. Claude and Figma Make. A working prototype, not a clickable one.

Note. State the method plainly. Two designers who built a functioning prototype in a week instead of filing an engineering request is a differentiator, and underselling it would be a waste.

PANEL 108 · The persona toggle

Visual. The top of the prototype. A toggle with four options: `BDM` · `CM` · `Buyer` · `Seller`.

> **NANDINI:** One prototype. Switch the toggle and you're the category manager. Switch again and you're the buyer.

Note. Genuinely clever and it gets its own panel. It is also what made a four-sided marketplace testable by two people in a room.

PANEL 109 · Rough

Visual. The interaction video. Visibly unpolished. A loader spinning longer than it should. Leave it in.

No dialogue.

Note. DO NOT CLEAN THIS UP. The roughness is the argument: this was a test, not a demo. A polished video here would undo the credibility that panel 22 bought.

PANEL 110 · Method

Visual. Call-out card.

> **METHOD · PROTOTYPE TEST**
> **[N]** days of building. **[N]** users across four roles. What was real: **[to fill]**. What was faked: **[to fill]**.

PANEL 111 · Go

Visual. Both designers. A decision made.

> **NANDINI:** They liked it.
> **VIK:** Two weeks to build it properly.

Transition into Act 4. Hard cut to a title beat. No wind-down.

Pacing check

Movement	Panels	Count
One: the method	64 to 67	4
Two: the brainstorm	68 to 76	9
Three: the cross-question	77 to 79	3
Four: the framework	80 to 86	7
Five: Connect	87 to 93	7
Six: Prism	94 to 100	7
Seven: the Prompt	101 to 103	3
Eight: doubt and prototype	104 to 111	8
Act 3 total		**48**

The framework block is seven panels, three of which are cards a reader can skim. That is the shortest it can be while still paying off the marker, and the reveal at 81 is what buys the patience for the other six.

Act 4 · The moment of truth, and Coda

Panels 112 to 151 · The moment of truth, and after

The evidentiary act. Everything before this was argument; this is the only part of the document that constitutes proof, and it only works if the reader believes it happened the way it is shown.

Tone. Flat and factual at the open. No manufactured tension, no nervous designers. The stakes are supplied by the fact that the inquiry is real and live, and the reader already knows what a lost order costs because they watched one.

The wart at panels 122 to 123 is the credibility beat. It is not an apology and it is not dwelt on. It is the reason the reader believes the rest.

Movement one: the setup

PANEL 112 · Title beat

Visual. Typographic. Clean.

> **Two weeks later.** Same BDM. A live inquiry from her own pipeline. Nothing staged.

Note. State the stakes once, plainly, and then never mention them again. A real deal with a real buyer waiting is all the tension this act needs.

PANEL 113 · The room

Visual. The two designers at the back of the room, watching her screen over her shoulder. Interested. Not anxious.

> **VIK:** We trained her on the basics and then we left her alone.

Note. Deliberately undramatic. They were curious, not nervous, and writing them as terrified would be the same error as claiming footage that does not exist.

PANEL 114 · Karishma

Visual. Karishma sits down at her laptop. Leaning slightly forward. She is interested in the new thing.

> **KARISHMA:** Okay. Show me.

M/A. 45 / 30

Note. She went in curious and pleased, not hostile. Do not manufacture scepticism she did not have.

PANEL 115 · Method

Visual. Call-out card, placed at the moment of the claim rather than in a footnote.

> **METHOD · RETEST**
> Trained on the basics, then left alone. A live inquiry from her own pipeline, not a scripted task. We did not intervene. Shared with her permission.

Note. Method disclosure at the point of the claim is what separates evidence from testimonial.

Movement two: the journey

PANEL 116 · A group that already exists

Visual. Connect. A group with Sunvik Corporation, already there, with history in it. A new message arrives.

> **KARISHMA:** This is my buyer. We've been talking in here for weeks.

M/A. 40 / 45

Note. No setup, no onboarding, no empty state. The most persuasive thing about Connect is that the conversation was already in it.

PANEL 117 · Forward

Visual. She shares the buyer's message straight into her category manager's group. One action.

No dialogue.

M/A. 45 / 55

Note. Callback to panel 59. In Act 2 this took a laptop, a phone and two hands.

PANEL 118 · THRESHOLD

Visual. She creates the inquiry from inside the chat. The thread comes with it, attached to the record.

> **KARISHMA:** And it keeps the whole conversation.

M/A. 50 / 65

Note. THE MARKER CROSSES THE ACTIVATION THRESHOLD HERE. The product's core move and the model's tipping point are the same panel. This was not engineered; it fell out of the scoring, and it is worth letting the chart show it without comment.

PANEL 119 · The mention

Visual. Inside the inquiry, she tags the category manager.

No dialogue.

M/A. 52 / 67

PANEL 120 · Prism

Visual. The Prism inbox. Every inquiry she owns, in one list, with status on each.

> **VIK:** We'd told her this is where all her inquiries live now.

M/A. 55 / 70

Note. PRISM IS EXPLAINED HERE AND NOWHERE EARLIER. No verbatim quote from her exists, so Vik narrates what they had told her before leaving her alone. Never put invented words in her mouth.

PANEL 121 · Buyer insight

Visual. She hovers a buyer name. A card opens: past orders, payment behaviour, what they usually buy.

> **KARISHMA:** It knows what he's bought before.

M/A. 60 / 72

Movement three: the wart

PANEL 122 · THE WART

Visual. She opens the Connect group to add her CM so he can see the buyer thread directly. The member search opens. One result is visible. The rest of the list is cut off below the fold of her screen.

> **KARISHMA:** Is that the only one?

M/A. 55 / 62

Note. REAL, AND IT HAPPENED IN THIS SESSION. She scrolls, finds him, and moves on within seconds. Keep it brief and do not make her struggle. The value is that it happened, not that it hurt. Note this is a different action from panel 119: there she mentioned him inside the inquiry, here she is adding him to the buyer group.

PANEL 123 · Owning it

Visual. Call-out card. Beside it, a small side-by-side: the same modal on a MacBook and on her Dell.

> **WHAT WE GOT WRONG**
> We designed and tested on MacBooks. Most of the sales floor runs Windows on smaller screens, so lists that fitted for us were cut in half for them. We found this here, redesigned it with engineering, and shipped the fix in the following release.

Note. THE CREDIBILITY BEAT OF THE DOCUMENT. Flat, unapologetic, specific, with a fix attached. A good run with a visible wart is more persuasive than a flawless one, and a reader who has been waiting for the marketing to show itself gets this instead.

Movement four: the other side

PANEL 124 · The CM

Visual. His screen. The mention appears. He opens it, and the buyer thread is right there.

No dialogue.

Note. The CM sequence is four panels and stays compressed. One emotional journey per document.

PANEL 125 · Recommended sellers

Visual. A ranked seller list with the reasons visible: category match, quality of quotes previously given, distance, terms of delivery.

> **CM:** It's telling me which ones to open first.

Note. Pays off panel 56. Frame it as discoverability, never as time saved. The ranking factors are real and should stay exactly as listed.

PANEL 126 · The nudge

Visual. An AI nudge beside a quote: a better rate is available from another seller. He adjusts and submits.

No dialogue.

PANEL 127 · The seller

Visual. WhatsApp on the seller's phone. The RFQ arrives there.

> **NANDINI:** The seller never logs in either.

Note. Quietly extends the thesis to a fourth party. One line, then move on.

Movement five: closing Obstacle 1

PANEL 128 · The quote

Visual. Back in Prism. The quote has come back. Rates against line items.

No dialogue.

M/A. 65 / 75

PANEL 129 · What she forgot to ask

Visual. The AI assistant, in the thread, conversational. `Before you send this across, you'll want the billing address and the first delivery date.`

> **KARISHMA:** Oh. Yes. I haven't asked him either of those.

M/A. 75 / 82

Note. THE PAYOFF OF OBSTACLE 1, planted at panel 39 and mentioned once in passing at panel 102. Everything the old form demanded she already know, arriving at the moment she actually needs it. Conversational register, never robotic: this panel dies if the assistant sounds like a form.

PANEL 130 · Then and now

Visual. Split panel, the same grammar as panels 6, 55 and 59. Left: the Act 2 form, blank mandatory fields, red asterisks. Right: the Act 4 assistant asking for two things at the moment they matter.

No dialogue. No caption.

M/A. 78 / 85

Note. Let the reader make the connection. They have been trained on this composition three times and will not need help.

PANEL 131 · The rate

Visual. She forwards the quote in the group. The buyer replies and approves the rate.

M/A. 85 / 88

PANEL 132 · The PO

Visual. The PO arrives in the chat.

> **KARISHMA:** He's sent the PO.

M/A. 90 / 90

Note. Peak before the drop. The reader should feel the act is finishing.

Movement six: the fake-out and the climax

PANEL 133 · FAKE-OUT

Visual. Her face falls. The energy goes out of the panel.

> **KARISHMA:** So now I have to fill in all of that data. All that paperwork.

M/A. 55 / 25

Note. THE MARKER PLUNGES BACK TOWARD RED. Do not signpost this and do not let anyone reassure her. The reader has watched thirty panels of exactly this grind and genuinely believes it is about to happen again. That belief is the entire mechanism.

PANEL 134 · Beat

Visual. Nothing moves. The dread sits.

No dialogue.

M/A. 55 / 25

PANEL 135 · The click

Visual. Her cursor moves to a button: `Proceed to Order`.

No dialogue.

M/A. 55 / 25

PANEL 136 · SHIMMER

Visual. Full bleed, screen only. A shimmer passes across the order form and every field fills itself. Line items, quantities, rates, delivery terms, billing address. Thirty of thirty.

No dialogue.

M/A. 95 / 95

Note. THE PANEL THE DOCUMENT EXISTS FOR. Screen only, no faces, no reaction, no text. The marker spikes. Whatever budget exists for animation belongs here.

PANEL 137 · Still

Visual. REAL FOOTAGE. Her hands, off the keyboard, motionless. No face.

No dialogue.

M/A. 95 / 95

Asset. Karishma desk footage. Face not visible.

Note. Stillness reads as astonishment and needs no face. The footage carries the fact; the next panel carries the emotion. Never blur the two.

PANEL 138 · Reaction

Visual. Illustrated Karishma, reacting. The character the reader has followed for 138 panels.

> **KARISHMA:** That's it?

M/A. 95 / 95

PANEL 139 · The CM's half

Visual. His screen. Prices already populated from the seller code. One approval button.

No dialogue.

M/A. 95 / 95

PANEL 140 · Placed

Visual. `ORDER PLACED`. Confirmation. The marker sits in the top-right corner of the green zone.

No dialogue.

M/A. 97 / 97

Coda

PANEL 141 · Debrief

Visual. REAL PHOTOGRAPH. The two of them at a whiteboard, numbers written up, a crowd in front of them.

> **VIK:** At the next town hall, this is what we presented.

PANEL 142 · The shape changes

Visual. THE FRAME ANIMATES DOWN from full-screen to a 16:9 band centred in the viewport.

No dialogue.

Note. A deliberate change in the shape of the story, marking a jump in time. The reader feels the document moving into its epilogue before being told. This is the only structural device of its kind in the piece, so it has to be unmistakable.

PANEL 143 · Four months

Visual. Montage. War rooms. Whiteboards. Real photographs, fast.

No dialogue.

PANEL 144 · In use

Visual. Adoption footage. Real BDMs, real screens, the thing running in the world.

No dialogue.

PANEL 145 · RESULT

Visual. Metric card, full width.

> **Six hours → sixty minutes** Time to punch an order.

PANEL 146 · RESULT

Visual. Metric card.

> **Orders per day: [X] → [Y]**

Note. CLAIM THE ORDERS. Let the revenue be inferred. Never state a revenue figure anywhere in this document. The restraint is the credibility.

PANEL 147 · RESULT

Visual. Metric card, and the untapped-leads number from panel 9 returns alongside it.

> **The BDMs went back to selling.** A team that had quietly become a data-entry function now has the hours to work the **[Y]** leads nobody had bandwidth for.

Note. STRUCTURAL BOOKEND. This closes the loop opened at panel 9, which is why that card was planted so early.

PANEL 148 · The journey

Visual. Full B=MAP. The complete line from the Act 2 floor, up through Connect, right through Prism, into the corner. The marker's whole trip in one image.

No dialogue.

M/A. 97 / 97

PANEL 149 · Takeaways

Visual. Card.

> **KEY TAKEAWAYS**
> **Match the software to the conversation, not the org chart.** The business ran on chats. The software demanded forms. Every hour lost was the cost of translating between the two.
> **Make effort follow intent.** The old system demanded its heaviest work at the coldest moment of a deal. Structured data should be the reward for a won order, not the price of starting one.
> **A required field you cannot answer does not protect your data.** It manufactures bad data, quietly, every day.

PANEL 150 · Gallery

Visual. The screens, properly. Connect, Prism, the AI layer, the CM view. For the reader who came for the craft.

No dialogue.

PANEL 151 · Close

Visual. Back to the two designers at the desk where the document opened. Same framing as panel 1. Hats off.

> **NANDINI:** Dhanda at Birla Pivot is still very simple.
> **VIK:** It just takes an hour now.

Note. Closing bookend to the first line of the document. The last line should land quietly and stop.

Pacing check

Movement	Panels	Count
One: the setup	112 to 115	4
Two: the journey	116 to 121	6
Three: the wart	122 to 123	2
Four: the other side	124 to 127	4
Five: closing Obstacle 1	128 to 132	5
Six: fake-out and climax	133 to 140	8
Act 4 total		**29**
Coda	141 to 151	11

Silent panels in Act 4: 117, 124, 126, 128, 130, 134, 135, 136, 137, 139, 140. Eleven of twenty-nine, almost all in the closing movement, where the visuals are doing the work and dialogue would only get in the way.

Appendix · Everything still open

Collected from across the four acts. Nothing here blocks a read-through.

Act 1

1. **[X]% and [Y] leads** at panel 9.
2. **The two optional Hindi lines** at panels 7 and 15.
3. **Whether panel 22's footage** is long enough to hold for a full panel, or whether it needs to be a still.

Act 2

1. **The timings** at panels 26, 52 to 54, 57. I have written the day as: requirement collected in the morning in the field, punching starts after lunch, prices land at 6:10 pm, buyer gone by evening. Correct anywhere you know better.
2. `CALL 6` at panel 62. Does six callbacks match reality, or was it more?
3. **The 8mm and 10mm** prices at panel 58 come from your screenshot. Confirm they are usable, or give me the real ones from the lost order.

Act 3

1. **[N] values** at panels 65 and 110.

2. **Panel 107** — confirm one week is right, and whether Figma Make and Claude are both nameable in a public piece.
3. **Panel 109** — does the rough video still exist in its unpolished state, or has it been re-recorded since?

Act 4 and Coda

1. **[X] and [Y]** at panels 146 and 147, plus the six-hours-to-sixty-minutes endpoints at 145.
2. **Panel 137** — confirm the footage has a usable moment at the point of the autofill, even three seconds of her hands going still. If not, cut the panel and let 138 carry it alone.
3. **Panel 129** — the assistant's real copy. What does it actually say when it flags missing information?
4. **Panel 141** — confirm the debrief photograph shows the whiteboard legibly, or whether the numbers need to be re-set as graphics over the photo.

Decisions taken, for the record

- **Cold open**: Variant A, the dhanda opening. The alternatives were starting at the two-device shot or starting at the lost deal; both were rejected for spending their strongest material on a reader with no reason to care yet.
- **The readout**: the B=MAP marker rather than a separate psych score, so Act 2's ambient widget and Act 3's framework are the same object.
- **Hindi**: kept to `dhanda` only. Two optional lines are flagged at panels 7 and 15.
- **Revenue**: never stated anywhere. Orders per day are claimed and revenue is left to be inferred.
- **The wart**: kept, in-session, at panels 122 and 123.

Also written, not included here

- **Panel map** — the full 151-row production spreadsheet with marker values, assets and pacing.
- **Voice guide** — the character specs and sample exchanges these scripts were written from.
- **Summary track** — the conventional case-study page that runs parallel to this for a scanning reader.
- **Narrative treatment** — the prose version of the arc, written before any of this.